

Evening Caffeine Intake and Sleep Latency: A Randomized Crossover Trial

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Abstract

This randomized crossover trial evaluated the effect of evening caffeine intake on sleep onset latency in healthy adults. Thirty-six participants received 200 mg caffeine or placebo three hours before bedtime on separate study nights.

Methods

Compared with placebo, 200 mg caffeine increased mean sleep onset latency from 14 minutes to 31 minutes. Total sleep time was reduced by 42 minutes after caffeine. The trial did not measure vocabulary recall, next-day memory performance, or academic achievement.

Conclusion

Evening caffeine delayed sleep onset and reduced total sleep time. The findings do not support caffeine as an intervention for faster sleep onset.